

Part 1: applicable to all students

Criterion	80-100% (A*)	70-79% (A)	60-69% (B)	50-59% (C)	40-49% (D)	1-39% (E)
Review and research framing	Extensive and systematic background research evaluating a multitude of credible sources (e.g. academic and policy) using an in-depth and thorough narrative that seamlessly leads the reader to an innovative globally pertinent or topical research question. There is unambiguous attribution of ideas and no inaccuracies.	A broad range of background research evaluating a multitude of credible sources (e.g. academic and policy) using an extensive narrative to produce a convincing framing of a highly pertinent or topical research question. There is clear attribution of ideas with few inaccuracies.	A range of background research evaluating multiple forms of credible sources (e.g. academic and policy) with an adequately developed narrative to produce a legitimate framing of the pertinent or topical research question. Attribution of ideas is mostly clear with some minor inaccuracies.	Background research considering several credible sources to produce a plausible framing of the somewhat pertinent or topical research question with a fairly adequate narrative. A more appropriate variation of the research question could have been proposed. Attribution of ideas is basic and irregular with some inaccuracies.	Limited background research considering few credible sources, producing an implausible framing of a vaguely pertinent or topical research question with no narrative. The research question should be reconsidered. Attribution of ideas is insufficient with major inaccuracies.	No evidence of relevant background research, with an illogical and irrelevant and/or untropical research question. The section requires a full re-write. There is no attribution of ideas.
Research design	An innovative, expertly explained and fully, easily reproducible research design that is based on an exceptionally robust choice of data	An original, refined, fully explained and fully reproducible research design that is based on an entirely appropriate choice of data and methods. It	A robust, well explained and mostly reproducible research design that is based on a well justified choice of data and methods. It demonstrates	A sound and adequately documented, broadly reproducible research design that is based on a plausible choice of data and methods. It	An unclear and insufficiently documented research design that is based on an ill-justified choice of data and methods. . There is very limited	An incomplete or highly deficient research design marked by an unjustified or inappropriate choice of data and methods.

	and methods. It demonstrates creativity, a comprehensive understanding of appropriate sophisticated techniques, exemplary technical proficiency and skills and extensive, critical ethical reflection.	demonstrates excellent understanding of appropriate techniques, technical proficiency and skills and critical ethical reflection.	competent understanding of analytical techniques, sound technical ability and ethical reflection.	demonstrates sound understanding of techniques taught in the programme, basic technical knowledge and some ethical awareness.	evidence of knowledge and understanding of techniques taught in the programme alongside scant ethical reflection.	There is no evidence of knowledge and understanding of techniques taught in the programme and no ethical awareness.
Analysis and critical reflection of findings	Interpretations of results are exceptionally well-constructed, clear and focused with a seamless narrative throughout. The discussion provides exemplary critical reflection on the project's outcomes, strengths and limitations with extensive links to current academic and policy (if applicable) debates.	Interpretations of results are very well constructed, clear and focused with a well-developed narrative throughout. The discussion provides appropriate critical reflections on the project's outcomes, strengths and limitations with good links to relevant academic and policy (if applicable) debates.	Interpretations of results are cogent and logically constructed argument with a consistent narrative throughout. Critical reflections on the project's outcomes, strengths and limitations are present within the discussion with some linkage to academic and policy (if applicable) debates.	Interpretations of results are simple and plausibly constructed with an adequate narrative that may lack detail in parts. Awareness of the project's outcomes, strengths and limitations is evident and basic reference is made to academic or policy (if appropriate) debates.	Interpretations of results are illogical, vague and ambiguous, without coherent narrative. Critical reflections are limited and with no or scant reference to academic or policy (if appropriate) debates.	Results have not been interpreted and there is no evidence of any critical reflection.
Visualisation and communication	Visualisations, maps, figures and outputs are entirely appropriate and	Visualisations, maps, figures and outputs are highly capable and refined for the data	Visualisations, maps, figures and outputs are clear and appropriate/effective	Visualisations, maps, figures and outputs are basic and plausible but more appropriate	Visualisations, maps, figures and outputs are poor and do not aid understanding in	Visualisations, maps, figures and outputs are bad or missing entirely. Any present

insightful for the data and analysis, and are of publication quality. Visualisations convey information expertly, demonstrating innovation and excellent design practice. The writing throughout is of exceptional quality, engaging and clear, being of publication quality.	and analysis, and are of high quality. Visualisations effectively convey information and demonstrate excellent design practice. The writing is of very high quality, engaging and clear.	but would benefit from slight improvements (e.g. too much irrelevant detail, or limitations in the visualisation type selected). The writing is of adequate quality and clear.	versions could have been implemented. The writing quality is rather basic and mostly clear.	any way. Maps and visualisations may lack even basic features such as legends, and the design quality is poor. The writing is haphazard in places, has poor structure and lacks clarity.	maps and visualisations may be full of major problems, irrelevant and produce confusion for the reader. The writing is very illogical, difficult to understand and lacks any structure.
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Each of these for components will make up 25% of your mark.

Distribution of marks for part 1, applicable to all students

Please note, poor academic practice or academic misconduct will be reported to the Module Convenor in the first instance who will follow the relevant policies outlined in the UCL academic manual, [Chapter 6, section 9](#). This is applicable to both Part 1 and Part 2.